

Terms & Conditions

PARALLAX 2026 — 24-Hour Hackathon

Organised by the School of Electronics, VIT Chennai

Last Updated: [Insert Date]

These Terms & Conditions (“Terms”) govern registration for and participation in PARALLAX 2026 (“Parallax” or “the Hackathon”), organised by the School of Electronics, Vellore Institute of Technology (VIT), Chennai.

By registering for PARALLAX 2026, participants agree to comply with these Terms, the accompanying Event Guidelines, and any additional instructions communicated by the organisers.

1. Eligibility

- Open to students from all branches and all years of Engineering.
- Teams may comprise both VIT and Non-VIT participants; cross-college teams are permitted and encouraged.
- Participants may be required to provide valid College ID cards for verification. Non-VIT participants must additionally carry a valid Bonafide Certificate, Approval Letter, or OD (On Duty) Letter issued by their institution.
- The organisers reserve the right to verify participant eligibility before or during the event; entry will be permitted only after successful verification.

2. Registration

- Participants must complete the official registration process within the announced registration period.
- Providing false, misleading or deliberately inaccurate registration information may result in cancellation of registration or disqualification.
- Registration will be considered confirmed only after completion of all applicable registration requirements.

3. Teams

- Each team must consist of 3 to 5 members.
- During registration, every team must select one official problem statement of their desired domain through the website, and the submitted project must align with the selected domain.
- A participant may ordinarily be registered as part of only one participating team unless otherwise permitted by the organisers.
- Changes to team composition after registration may be restricted and will be subject to approval by the organisers.

4. Problem Statements

- Hardware problem statements will be released 108 hours prior to the hackathon start.
- Software problem statements will be released 12 hours before the locking time.

- Both hardware and software problem statements will be locked by 16th August (Sunday), 5:00 PM.

5. Registration Fees

- Where a registration fee is applicable, participants must complete payment through the officially designated registration platform or payment method.
- Payment of a registration fee does not exempt participants from eligibility, verification or conduct requirements.
- Any applicable cancellation or refund conditions will be communicated through official event channels or the registration platform.

6. Reporting, Attendance & Participation

- All participants must report to the venue by 12:30 PM for registration and verification, carrying valid identification as specified under Eligibility.
- All team members are required to be present during registration and verification, and are expected to remain available throughout the hackathon, including mentoring sessions, interim evaluations (if any), and the final project presentation.
- Every team member is expected to actively contribute to the project. The Organizing Committee must be informed immediately in case of an emergency or unavoidable absence.
- Failure to comply with attendance requirements may affect a team's eligibility for evaluation or awards, at the discretion of the Organizing Committee.
- Participants must follow instructions issued by faculty coordinators, organisers and authorised VIT Chennai personnel, and remain within authorised event areas where required.

7. Overnight & Venue Policy

- Participants are free to move within the VIT Chennai campus until 7:30 PM.
- From 7:30 PM onwards, participants must remain within the designated hackathon venue; exiting the venue or campus will not be permitted for security reasons.
- In exceptional circumstances where a participant cannot stay overnight, prior approval must be obtained from the Organizing Committee. Approved participants must exit the campus before 6:30 PM and immediately inform the Organizing Committee of the situation.

8. Participant Requirements & Amenities

- Participants must bring their own personal laptop(s), laptop charger(s), and any hardware components or accessories required for their project. An extension box is recommended where additional power outlets are needed.
- The Organizing Committee will provide internet connectivity, continuous power supply, and one extension box per team.
- Complimentary dinner and breakfast will be provided to all registered participants during the hackathon; no other refreshments will be provided.

9. Code of Conduct

- Parallax is intended to provide a safe, respectful and inclusive environment for all participants.
- Harassment, intimidation, discrimination, threats, abusive behaviour, deliberate disruption or other inappropriate conduct will not be tolerated.
- Possession or consumption of prohibited substances, smoking, or other activities prohibited by applicable VIT Chennai rules are not permitted.
- Both VIT and Non-VIT participants must strictly adhere to the VIT Code of Conduct throughout the event (available at vit.ac.in/Student-Code-of-Conduct.pdf).
- Serious violations may result in immediate removal from the event and may be referred to appropriate university authorities where necessary.

10. Project Development & Use of AI Tools

- Every project submitted must be the original work of the participating team. Previously developed projects, plagiarism, or any form of academic dishonesty will result in immediate disqualification.
- The use of AI-assisted development tools (such as ChatGPT, GitHub Copilot, Gemini, Claude, etc.) is permitted. However, participants must clearly understand their implementation and be able to explain any part of their solution during evaluation.
- Use of open-source libraries, APIs, development tools, frameworks or other external resources may be permitted subject to the rules announced for the relevant problem statement or competition category.
- Participants remain responsible for ensuring that their submissions do not knowingly violate applicable intellectual property rights.

11. Intellectual Property

- Unless otherwise specifically stated for a particular problem statement, participants retain ownership of intellectual property created by them during the Hackathon.
- Participants are responsible for ensuring that they have appropriate rights or permissions for third-party materials incorporated into their projects.
- By presenting a project at Parallax, participants permit the organisers to photograph, record, display or describe the project for legitimate event documentation, reporting and promotional purposes.

12. Evaluation and Judging

- Projects may be evaluated according to criteria announced by the organisers.
- Decisions of the designated judging panel regarding evaluation, ranking and awards will be final and binding for the purposes of the Hackathon.
- Attempts to manipulate judging, misrepresent work, plagiarise another team's work, or otherwise obtain an unfair advantage may result in disqualification.

13. Certificates and Awards

- Certificates will be issued subject to applicable participation requirements and verification of participant information.
- Participants are responsible for providing accurate details required for certificate generation.
- Awards, prizes or other recognitions, where applicable, will be subject to the rules and eligibility conditions announced by the organisers.

14. Photography & Media Consent

- By participating in PARALLAX 2026, participants consent to being photographed, filmed, or recorded during the event.
- The organisers reserve the right to use such photographs, videos and recordings for documentation, publicity, promotional activities and social media, without requiring further consent.

15. Liability & Participant Property

- Participants are solely responsible for the safety and security of their personal belongings, laptops, hardware components, and any other equipment brought to the venue.
- While reasonable precautions will be taken to ensure a secure environment, the Organizing Committee shall not be held responsible for any loss, theft, or damage to personal property.
- Any emergency, safety concern or inappropriate behaviour should be reported promptly to an organiser, faculty coordinator, security personnel or other authorised university personnel.

16. Schedule and Event Changes

- The organisers may modify the event schedule, venue, format, judging process, problem statements or other operational aspects where reasonably necessary.
- Participants will be informed of significant changes through appropriate official communication channels.
- In circumstances beyond reasonable organisational control, the event may be postponed, modified or cancelled.

17. Disqualification or Removal

The organisers may disqualify or remove a participant or team for reasons including:

- Violation of these Terms or the event Code of Conduct;
- Providing fraudulent registration information;
- Plagiarism or misrepresentation of project work;
- Serious misconduct;
- Interference with the operation of the Hackathon;
- Failure to comply with reasonable safety, security, or attendance instructions; or
- Violation of applicable VIT Chennai rules.

The nature of any action taken will depend on the circumstances and severity of the violation.

18. Event Communications

Important announcements may be communicated through the official Parallax website, email, registration platform or other communication channels designated by the organisers. Participants are responsible for monitoring official communications for updates relating to the event.

19. Organizer's Decision

The Organizing Committee reserves the right to amend the event schedule, rules, or guidelines whenever deemed necessary in the interest of the event. The decisions of the Organizing Committee and the judging panel shall be final and binding in all matters relating to PARALLAX 2026.

20. Acceptance of Terms

By registering for PARALLAX 2026, participants acknowledge that they have read and agree to comply with these Terms & Conditions, the Privacy Policy, the Code of Conduct, the Event Guidelines, and other applicable rules communicated by the organisers.

21. Contact

For questions regarding these Terms & Conditions, please contact:

PARALLAX 2026 Organising Team

School of Electronics, VIT Chennai

admin@parallax2026.in

Privacy Policy

PARALLAX 2026 — 24-Hour Hackathon

Organised by the School of Electronics, VIT Chennai

Last Updated: [Insert Date]

PARALLAX 2026 (“Parallax”, “the Hackathon”, “we”, “us”, or “our”) is a 24-hour hackathon organised by the School of Electronics, Vellore Institute of Technology (VIT), Chennai.

This Privacy Policy explains how information provided by participants in connection with PARALLAX 2026 may be collected, used, and handled.

1. Information We Collect

During registration and participation in PARALLAX 2026, participants may be required to provide information including:

- Full name
- Email address
- Phone number
- College/University name
- Registration or student identification details, where required
- College ID, Bonafide Certificate, Approval Letter, or OD Letter details (for verification of Non-VIT participants)
- Team name, Team ID and team member details
- Selected problem statement and project domain
- Participation and payment status
- Information required for participant verification
- Information required for certificates and event administration

Additional information may be collected where reasonably necessary for the organisation and conduct of the Hackathon.

2. How We Use Your Information

Participant information may be used for purposes including:

- Processing and verifying registrations
- Confirming participant and team eligibility
- Communicating important event information and updates
- Managing teams, problem-statement allocation, and participant attendance
- Event administration and coordination
- Issuing participation, achievement or other applicable certificates
- Maintaining event records

- Ensuring compliance with event rules, the Code of Conduct, and safety requirements
- Resolving registration or participation-related issues

Participant information will not be sold or used for unrelated commercial purposes by the Parallax organising team.

3. Registration and Third-Party Platforms

Registration, payment, communication, or other event-related services may be provided through platforms or services operated by VIT Chennai or third-party service providers. Information submitted through such platforms may also be subject to the respective platform's privacy practices and policies. Parallax is not responsible for the privacy practices of independently operated third-party websites or services.

4. Photographs, Video and Event Media

Photographs, video recordings and other media may be captured during PARALLAX 2026 for documentation, reporting, publicity and promotional purposes, including on social media.

By attending the event, participants acknowledge and consent to being photographed, filmed or recorded, and that they may appear in such photographs or recordings, which may be used by the organisers without requiring further consent.

Where individual interviews, testimonials or dedicated promotional recordings are conducted, appropriate consent may be obtained where applicable.

5. Access to Participant Information

Participant information may be accessible to authorised members of the organising team, faculty coordinators, relevant VIT Chennai personnel and service providers where necessary for the organisation and administration of the event. Reasonable efforts will be made to restrict access to participant information to persons who require it for legitimate event-related purposes.

6. Data Retention

Participant information may be retained for a reasonable period after the completion of PARALLAX 2026 for purposes such as event records, certificate verification, administrative requirements and resolution of participant queries. Information that is no longer reasonably required may subsequently be removed or archived in accordance with applicable institutional practices.

7. Participant Responsibility

Participants are responsible for ensuring that information submitted during registration is accurate and up to date. When providing information relating to other team members, participants should ensure that such information is provided with their knowledge and permission.

8. Security

Reasonable organisational and technical measures may be used to protect participant information against unauthorised access, disclosure, alteration or misuse. However, no electronic storage or transmission system can be guaranteed to be completely secure.

9. Changes to This Privacy Policy

This Privacy Policy may be updated where necessary to reflect changes in event procedures, registration requirements or applicable policies. The latest version published on the official Parallax website will apply.

10. Contact

For questions regarding this Privacy Policy or the handling of participant information, please contact:

PARALLAX 2026 Organising Team

School of Electronics, VIT Chennai

admin@parallax2026.in